

Client Growth Strategy Meeting

The Outreach Call Playbook.

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THE BIG IDEA Stop saving clients. Start selling them. Two upsells offset one cancellation — but only if you hold the line, read the room, and replace discounts with backlinks.

1. Outreach infrastructure

Before any of the scripting matters, the call schedule has to be built right. One workbook for the rollout — one tab per rep, calls laid out across Monday through Friday.

How to build it

- One workbook for the whole outreach rollout (~6–8 weeks).
- One tab per rep — click the tab, see that rep's week at a glance.
- Calls slotted across Monday → Friday.
- Stack four calls per slot. Why four? Because roughly one in four contacts will defer — "I'm busy, let me catch up." Build the schedule expecting the back-burner.

"One in four callers is probably going to put you on the back burner. Build the schedule expecting it — don't get caught short."

2. Read the room (before you open your mouth)

One rep this week pitched a client who was actually performing well — 8 of 10 keywords on page one. The rep opened with a low-energy concern frame: 'I'm not really happy with how things are going.' The client took it and ran. 'Yeah, since you guys took over, nothing's really happened.' The rep then had to backpedal and rescue the call.

The mistake: following the script blind, instead of adapting it to a green-status account.

What the opening should have been

"I'm actually quite pleased with the results we're getting. Eight on page one. But what we could be doing is getting a lot more for you."

Same call, same script structure — but framed from strength, not weakness. The client now has nothing to push back on.

THE RULE Diagnose the account before you read the script. Green accounts get pitched from strength. Red accounts get pitched from concern. Mix them up and you'll lose both.

3. The ambush advantage

When you call up a client and they don't know you're calling, you have a significant advantage. The only information they have to react to is the information you feed them. Take a position first. Tell them what's in their head before they tell you what's in theirs.

Why this matters

- Leave the silence open and the client will fill it — usually with the worst-case version: "I'm wanting to cancel," "I'm worried about the economy," "I'm waiting on the election."
- Take a position first and you control the frame. They'll vibe off whatever you say.
- This is the whole reason cold outreach beats inbound: they didn't prepare a script. You did.

"I take a position first. I tell them what's in their head. Because if you leave it alone, they'll get caught up in their own story and the call is gone."

4. The economy frame

Right now, the room is full of fear. Inflation, interest rates, federal budget cuts, election noise. Most reps are walking on eggshells around it. Don't. Lean in. The fear is the opening.

How to use it

Frame the economy as the reason to stay invested — not the reason to cut back. The talk track:

"I know your business is going well, and I know a lot of your work is referral. But things are going to slow down — and you need to be on page one now. Now. Everyone else is going to cut their marketing spend. Be the change you want to see. Don't wait to feel it on your books — get on the jump."

Why this works

- Most accountants will tell their clients to cut marketing first. That's the conversation you're competing against. Pre-empt it.
- Once you cut revenue, everything else falls behind it. Frame marketing as a revenue line, not a cost line.
- If you sound like a business person — talking economy, cycles, positioning — you sound like an expert. If you sound like a product person, you sound like a salesperson.

WATCH-OUT Don't get political. The economy frame is about positioning the client to lean in — it's not a vehicle for your views. Keep it commercial.

5. The ABC of clients in this economy

When the climate gets uncertain, every client sorts themselves into one of three types. Knowing which one you're talking to changes the call.

Type	Posture	What they do
A — Aggressor	Leans in	Doubles down. Spends into the downturn. Takes share while competitors retreat.

B — Watcher	Drifts	Waits to see what happens. Status quo until a real event forces a decision. Eventually slides down.
C — Retracted	Pulls out	Already decided to cut. Cancelling subscriptions, killing marketing, hiding.

Most of your clients are B's, drifting. Unless you lean into them hard, the drift turns into a C — they'll pull out. Your job on the call is to push them up the ladder, not down it.

6. Offensive vs defensive — the maths

There's a mindset split between trying to save clients with discounts (defensive) and trying to upsell into the relationship (offensive). The maths is brutal on the defensive side.

The example

An \$850 package upsold from a \$200 base = roughly a 60% increase in account value. Do two of those upsells and you've absorbed the revenue hit of an entire lost client. Try to save that client with a 10% discount and you've done two things at once: reduced your dollar value AND eventually lost them anyway.

Defensive (save)	Offensive (sell)
Lead with discount	Lead with value add
Try to keep every client	Let weak accounts fall on their own sword
Reduces dollar value per account	Increases dollar value per account
Loses the client anyway, 6 months later	Loses the client and replaces them with two upsells
Mindset: retention	Mindset: growth

"Forget retention — I'll get that anyway. I'm not interested in negotiating at the retention level, because I know I'm not that good. I'm a greedy operator. That's the mindset."

Note: this is not a licence to torch the client base. It's a permission slip to stop apologising on price. The clients who only stay because of discounts were never the clients you wanted.

7. The anchor-drop pricing dance

When you go in with a number, don't go in with the number you want. Go in higher. Anchor on the top tier, signal it's overkill, then come back later with the middle tier framed as a special favour.

The sequence

1. Expose the \$1,400 package. Frame it: "Look, I think this is overkill — but I want you to see it."
2. Recommend the \$850 tier. "I think we should start at \$850. Let me have a talk to the director, think about it."
3. Let them marinate. Don't close on the call. Walk away, give them time to choke on the \$850 number.
4. Come back 24–48 hours later by email or text: "I've had a look at your campaign. I feel really strong about this. I've got the director's approval — if you want to do it, I'll give it to you at \$550."
5. Bonus: "And because you're a nice guy, I'll waive the setup fee if you make a decision today."

Why this works

- The \$1,400 anchor makes \$850 sound reasonable.
- The \$850 marination makes \$550 feel like a win, not a discount.
- "Director's approval" raises the perceived value of the concession — it's not a fire sale, it's a personal favour.
- If they were going to sign at \$850 anyway, you lose \$300. If they were on the edge, the drop tips them over. A bird in the hand.

"Let them marinate on the \$850. Let them choke on it for a bit. Let their brain expand around the number — and then vacuum it down to \$550. You've created the space for the \$550."

8. The discount trap — Trojan-horse backlinks

When a client wants to cancel, the instinct is to discount. Don't. Replace the discount with a value-add that costs you less and locks them in deeper. Backlinks. Web work hours. Anything that takes effect later and proves itself in three months.

The script

"I've literally found a way to not reduce your price — but I've authorized something I'm not supposed to. Don't tell anyone. I've added [three hours of web work / five backlinks] to your account. It'll take effect over the next three months."

Why backlinks beat a discount

- They cost you almost nothing.
- They take three months to show results — which means in three months you've got a fresh reason to ring back.
- The follow-up writes itself: "Remember those backlinks? Look at your rankings now. Now — about referrals..."

- They reassure the client that the save was real. Discounts make the client feel they over-paid before.
- "I authorized something I'm not supposed to" raises the perceived value of the gesture without you having to discount.

THE TROJAN HORSE A discount ends the conversation. A backlink package opens the next one. Three months from now, you walk back in with results and ask for the upsell.

9. The 3-day follow-up

From now on, every time a client saves or makes a change to their account, there's a follow-up call exactly three working days later. Not seven. Three.

The call

"Just calling to let you know everything's running smoothly on the account. And — I've taken the liberty of adding three hours of web work to your account, because I know you wanted to save some money. I couldn't quite do that, but I've added three hours of web work."

Why three days

- Reassures the client they made the right decision while the doubt is still fresh.
- Pre-empts the second cancellation conversation. (One client this week cancelled twice in four weeks — the gap closed it.)
- Gives the rep an excuse to ring without sounding desperate or salesy.
- The freebie locks in the goodwill. The save becomes a story the client tells themselves about how well they're being looked after.

10. The corner metaphor — holding the line

Anyone can hold the throttle flat out on the straight. Where you actually win the race is in the corners — and corners are won by whoever can pull the brake lever the latest and hardest.

"Anyone can hold the throttle flat out. But where you win the race is in the corners. He or she who can hold off and pull in the brake lever the latest, wins the corner. Win the corner, win the race."

How this applies to a call

- The corner is the moment the client pushes back on price. That's the brake.
- Hold the line. Don't buckle. "With all due respect to your accountant, it's a very easy thing to say chop the budget — but don't chop it from us. We're the line item bringing the revenue in."
- The client will respect you more for holding the line than for folding. The one who folds first loses the corner.

Real example from this week: a client called to cancel on accountant's orders. The rep held the line — 26 keywords on page one, all the inbound work coming from us, lowest

membership tier, nowhere to move on price. By the end of the call: "Oh wow, I'm the dumb one — let me go tell my accountant."

Action items

For the rollout

6. Build the outreach workbook — one tab per rep, calls slotted Monday → Friday, four calls per slot.
7. Get the rollout schedule finalised for next week.
8. Script the new outreach pitch (read-the-room opener, ABC framing, anchor-drop, Trojan-horse fallback).
9. Record the new pitch into a Synthesia training video.
10. Deploy the video to every rep on Teams — everyone watches before they pick up the phone next week.

For the reps

11. Diagnose the account before the script — green vs red status.
12. Green accounts: open from strength ("pleased with results, but we could be getting more").
13. Red accounts: open from concern ("we need to talk about the campaign").
14. On every save call: 3-working-day follow-up locked in the diary before you hang up.
15. Replace every discount with a value-add (backlinks, web work hours).